

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Diverse Perspectives on Justice - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Diverse Perspectives on Justice

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Perspective Map, Stakes and Essential Vocabulary

2 The Eight-Perspective Chapter Spine

3 Rawls, Nozick and Controlling Distinctions

4 Thinkers and Rival Standards of Justice

5 Illustrative Cases and Evidence Units

6 The Six-Axis Comparative Matrix

7 Trap Repair, Boundaries and PYQ Routes

8 Revision Spine and Directive Control

9 Argument Reconstruction and Objection-Reply Chains

10 Indian Applications, Quotation Safety and MCQ Ledger

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Generation: learner-v2:g4 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A scholarship board compares citizens' access to liberties, offices, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. Which account identifies the relevant bundle?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Primary goods** with **Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

A court asks what citizens receive in liberties, opportunities and means. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Primary goods** with **Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Constitution-designers must select principles before knowing which social position they will occupy. Which account identifies the choice situation itself?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Original position** with **Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Constitution-makers are modelled before bargaining power is known. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- C. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- D. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Original position** with **Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Negotiators know general social facts but are denied knowledge of their own class, talents and rank. Which account identifies this informational restriction?

- A. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Veil of ignorance** with **The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

A rule is made without knowing one's future status. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Veil of ignorance** with **The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

A government proposes suppressing political criticism because the resulting stability would finance larger transfers. Which account rules out this bargain?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal basic liberties** with **Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

A welfare plan curbs free speech to aid the poor. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal basic liberties** with **Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Public posts are legally open to all, yet inherited schooling advantages determine who can compete effectively. Which account diagnoses the remaining injustice?

- A. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fair equality of opportunity** with **Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Elite schooling makes office legal but unreal for most citizens. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fair equality of opportunity** with **Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

A pay differential is defended only after showing that it improves the position of those worst placed. Which source-grounded account tests the claim?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Difference principle** with **Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Higher rewards are allowed because the worst-off become better off. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Difference principle** with **Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

An auditor refuses to compare final shares and instead traces how every holding was acquired, transferred and corrected. Which account guides the inquiry?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Entitlement theory** with **Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

A claimant rejects end-state equality and reconstructs title history. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Entitlement theory** with **Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

A policy treats a person's body and talents as resources available for compulsory social use. Which account supplies the objection?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Self-ownership** with **persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Taxation is attacked as using one person's talents for another. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.
- D. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Self-ownership** with **persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

A constitution confines government to policing force and fraud, enforcing contracts and correcting proven wrongs. Which account best explains the limit?

- A. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Minimal protective state** with **legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Government polices and adjudicates but refuses patterned welfare design. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Minimal protective state** with **legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

An initially equal distribution changes because thousands voluntarily pay to watch one athlete. Which account explains why the new pattern matters?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Wilt Chamberlain example** with **repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Many fans pay one player and inequality grows through choice. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Wilt Chamberlain example** with **repeated voluntary transfers can disrupt a preferred distribution and require continual interference to restore it**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

One owner acquires the only dependable water supply and can now dictate terms to an entire settlement. Which account exposes the limit on acquisition?

- A. appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Water-source example** with **appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Someone controls the only water source and subjects all to private discretion. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.
- C. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Water-source example** with **appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

A present possessor bought land lawfully, but the chain begins in forced dispossession. Which account prevents the latest transfer from settling justice?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled.
- D. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rectification principle** with **injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

A recent sale is valid, but the asset began in dispossession. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- B. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.
- C. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- D. injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rectification principle** with **injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

A factory's workforce produces output worth more than wages and operating replacement, while owners retain the remainder. Which account diagnoses the relation?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Surplus value** with **labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Ownership captures unpaid labour time through production. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- B. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Surplus value** with **labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

A movement combines social ownership and universal welfare with civil liberties, multiparty competition and accountable government. Which account fits?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Democratic socialism** with **welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Public services expand while dictatorship is rejected. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.
- D. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Democratic socialism** with **welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Local associations coordinate mutual aid through federation and consent rather than a coercive central hierarchy. Which account best explains the ideal?

- A. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- B. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Voluntary cooperation** with **anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Small federated groups reject coercive central rule. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Voluntary cooperation** with **anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

A formally neutral care policy leaves one gender carrying unpaid burdens that block property, office and voice. Which account reveals why sameness is insufficient?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist corrective equality** with **identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

A neutral rule leaves women excluded from property and power. Which account applies most directly?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist corrective equality** with **identical treatment is inadequate where gendered structures require compensatory support and effective participation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

A community performs indispensable labour yet remains absent from elite histories, public honour and decision-making. Which account identifies the injustice?

- A. justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
- B. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Subaltern justice** with **justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Groups produce social wealth yet remain marginal under elite narratives. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
- C. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Subaltern justice** with **justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

A hierarchy survives partly because schools, media and everyday language present it as natural common sense. Which account explains that durability?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual.
- D. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hegemony** with **domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Public culture makes subordination seem like common sense. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. labour creates value beyond the wage returned to the worker, while ownership permits appropriation of the remainder.
- B. welfare, partial socialisation and social justice are combined with civil liberties and competitive democracy.
- C. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- D. domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hegemony** with **domination persists partly by making elite interests and unequal arrangements appear natural or consensual**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

A political argument begins with identities formed through language, membership and shared practices rather than an isolated chooser. Which account fits?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Situated / embedded self** with **Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

A theory rejects the isolated chooser and starts from shared practices. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- B. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Situated / embedded self** with **Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

A wealthy citizen tries to convert money into public office, educational rank and medical priority. Which account rejects that cross-sphere dominance?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Complex equality** with **one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Wealth cannot buy office or educational rank across unlike goods. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- C. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- D. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Complex equality** with **one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

An answer defends a limited inequality by tracing how socially connected gains reach those at the weakest link. Which account identifies this explanatory device?

- A. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- B. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Chain connection** with **Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

An answer explains Rawls through social interdependence, not a separate principle. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
- C. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- D. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Chain connection** with **Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Two people receive identical resources, but disability and social barriers leave only one able to convert them into mobility and work. Which account best diagnoses the gap?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Capability approach** with **Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Two citizens get the same support, but only one converts it into real freedom. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Capability approach** with **Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

A group receives redistribution but remains excluded from agenda-setting and equal standing in public debate. Which account states the missing standard?

- A. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- B. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Parity of participation** with **Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

A group gets funds but lacks equal standing in decisions. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Parity of participation** with **Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Material support rises while public stigma, humiliation and status subordination remain unchanged. Which account identifies the surviving wrong?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs.
- D. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mis-recognition** with **status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Funds arrive, but the group remains publicly dishonoured and unheard. Which account applies most directly?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mis-recognition** with **status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owner is Social and Political Ideals. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2019 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: How far do you think John Rawls is continuing with Plato's concept of justice?

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **How far**: answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis. Rawls continues Plato only in a broad architectonic sense -- justice as the virtue that structures a well-ordered whole -- and breaks with him radically on method, citizenship and equality. State the criterion of "continuity" first.

- **Continuity.** For Plato, justice is right-order: each part of soul and city performs its own function in harmony. For Rawls, justice is the first virtue of the basic structure -- fair terms of cooperation among free and equal persons. Both make justice the ORDERING virtue of the social whole, not one desire among others.

- **Break 1 -- method.** Plato reaches justice through the metaphysics of the Forms and functional differentiation; Rawls through a hypothetical device, the original position under a veil of ignorance -- a device of representation, not a cosmology.

- **Break 2 -- equality and citizenship.** Plato's order is a fixed hierarchy of natural kinds; Rawls builds in equal basic liberties and fair equality of opportunity for equal citizens, explicitly rejecting caste-like closure.

Verdict. The continuity is thin (justice as the structure of a good society); the discontinuity is deep (democratic-egalitarian method against fixed hierarchy). Rawls inherits Plato's QUESTION, not his ANSWER.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the axis of continuity before judging, and separates a shared question from opposed answers instead of forcing a single verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "How far do you think John Rawls is continuing with Plato's concept of justice?" - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2021 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: Discuss critically the distributive theory of justice as propounded by R. Nozick.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Discuss**: cover the principal dimensions, connect named evidence to each claim, include the strongest counter-position and conclude directly. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis. Nozick's is a HISTORICAL (entitlement) theory, not a distributive one in the patterned sense: a distribution is just if it arose through just steps, whatever its final shape. Powerful as a warning, it is incomplete on its own premises.

- **Doctrine.** Justice in holdings has three principles -- justice in ACQUISITION

(how unowned things are first justly held), justice in TRANSFER (voluntary exchange and gift) and justice in RECTIFICATION (correcting past injustice). There is no required end-state pattern.

- **Historical vs patterned.** Patterned principles (equality, need, merit) judge

the shape of the distribution; historical principles judge the PROCESS. The Wilt Chamberlain argument shows that if people freely pay to watch him, the resulting inequality is just, and maintaining any fixed pattern would require continuous interference with voluntary transfers.

- **Critique.** The acquisition and rectification principles are the weakest

links: both need an independent criterion, and real starting distributions are tainted by conquest, coercion and background injustice, so "voluntariness" is rarely clean.

Verdict. Nozick's side-constraint, self-ownership warning against overreaching redistribution is a permanent contribution; but because his own foundational principles are under-specified, entitlement theory cannot bypass the problem of unjust starting points.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes the historical/patterned distinction, uses Wilt Chamberlain as argument (not decoration), and lands the critique on acquisition/rectification.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Discuss critically the distributive theory of justice as propounded by R. Nozick." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2021 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss whether Amartya Sen's idea of justice is an improvement upon Rawls's theory of justice.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Discuss**: cover the principal dimensions, connect named evidence to each claim, include the strongest counter-position and conclude directly. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Thesis. Whether Sen improves on Rawls is CRITERION-RELATIVE: judged by attention to realised freedom and remediable injustice Sen improves on Rawls; judged by the need for determinate institutional principles Rawls retains the advantage. Name the test before applying it.

- **Rawls in brief.** A just basic structure chosen behind the veil of ignorance:

equal basic liberties, fair equality of opportunity and the difference principle. Its focus is ideal, transcendental and institution-centred.

- **Sen's reorientation.** Sen contrasts NITI (correctness of rules and institutions) with NYAYA (justice realised in actual lives). A society may have fine rules yet produce grave injustice, so we should COMPARE feasible social states and remove manifest injustice rather than seek one perfectly just structure; the metric is CAPABILITIES, refined through PUBLIC REASONING.

- **The improvement, assessed.** By the criterion of realised freedom, Sen improves on Rawls -- primary goods ignore the diversity of conversion into real freedom, and transcendental design can neglect how people actually fare. But by the criterion of institutional determinacy, comparative ranking without an ideal benchmark can under-determine choice among rival improvements.

- **Rawlsian reply.** Institutions remain indispensable preconditions of justice; comparison still presupposes standards the ideal theory helps supply.

Verdict. Sen improves on Rawls in ORIENTATION (from arrangements to lives, from resources to capabilities), but does not simply supersede him; "improvement" holds only on a stated criterion, and both are needed.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it states the criterion of improvement first, uses niti/nyaya and capabilities as argument, concedes what Rawls still does better, and gives a criterion-relative verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Discuss whether Amartya Sen's idea of justice is an improvement upon Rawls's theory of justice." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2022 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain the difference between the notion of equity and equality with reference to Marxian philosophy.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Explain**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis. In Marxian philosophy, EQUALITY is the application of one common measure to all, while EQUITY is differentiated distribution responsive to real need; Marx's deeper claim is that formal equal right can be a right of INEQUALITY.

- **The distinction.** Equality = same standard for everyone (equivalent exchange among legal equals). Equity = shares differentiated by need and actual condition ("to each according to his need"). Equal treatment of unequally-placed people reproduces disadvantage.
- **Marx's argument.** Bourgeois equality abstracts from class structure. The wage contract LOOKS free and equal, but a right measured by a common standard is applied to people who differ in need, burden and family condition -- so equal right is, in content, a right of inequality; and the wage relation itself is structurally exploitative.
- **The two-stage caution.** The need-principle belongs to a HIGHER stage of cooperation where alienated labour and scarcity are transformed; it is not a market-time salary rule, and reading it as one invites the "vague / weakens incentive" objection.

Verdict. Equality and equity diverge because a single measure cannot be fair to unequal needs; Marx uses the distinction to expose the class content hidden beneath formally equal exchange.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes the measure-vs-need distinction, roots it in the equal-right-as-right-of-inequality argument, and flags the higher-stage qualification without drifting into a Political-Ideologies essay.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Explain the difference between the notion of equity and equality with reference to Marxian philosophy." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2023 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: What is meant by justice as fairness? Explain Rawls' theory of justice.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **What**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis. "Justice as fairness" means that the principles of justice are those that free and equal persons would choose under fair conditions; Rawls builds those conditions into the original position and derives two lexically ordered principles.

- **The device.** In the ORIGINAL POSITION, parties choose principles for the basic structure behind a VEIL OF IGNORANCE -- not knowing their class, sex, talents, religion or conception of the good. Ignorance of arbitrary advantage makes the choice fair; it is a device of representation, not a historical contract.

- **The two principles.** (1) Each has an equal claim to a fully adequate scheme of equal BASIC LIBERTIES. (2) Social and economic inequalities must satisfy (a) FAIR equality of opportunity and (b) the DIFFERENCE PRINCIPLE -- they may stand only if they benefit the LEAST ADVANTAGED.

- **Priority and justification.** Liberty is LEXICALLY prior (never traded for economic gain); fair opportunity precedes the difference principle. Justification proceeds by REFLECTIVE EQUILIBRIUM -- mutual adjustment of principles and considered judgments.

Verdict. Justice as fairness is a deontological liberal egalitarianism: liberty is basic, and inequality is tolerated only under fair opportunity and benefit to the least advantaged.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it defines fairness through the fair choice situation, states the principles with their PRIORITY, and adds reflective equilibrium rather than listing slogans.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "What is meant by justice as fairness? Explain Rawls' theory of justice." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 Q4(a), 20 marks

Question: How are both equality and liberty inadequate as social and political ideals without justice? Discuss.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **How**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Thesis. Equality and liberty are indispensable but INADEQUATE by themselves, because each is indeterminate about its own content; justice is the architectonic ideal that supplies the ordering criteria and decides their scope and priority.

- **Why liberty alone is inadequate.** "Liberty" does not tell us WHICH liberties are basic, or how to weigh one person's freedom against another's. A tyrant and a citizen both invoke freedom; negative, positive and republican conceptions pull apart. Only a theory of justice ranks basic liberties and protects them (Rawls's lexical priority).

- **Why equality alone is inadequate.** "Equality" is under-specified -- of status, rights, opportunity, welfare, resources, capability or outcome? Each metric yields different institutions, and without a criterion, equality collapses into either mechanical levelling or empty formalism.

- **What justice supplies.** Justice provides the adjudicatory criteria -- desert, fairness, entitlement, need, capability, rectification and public reason -- that say which inequalities are justified and which liberties are basic. Compare the positions: liberty-first (Nozick) protects self-ownership but lets background injustice hollow real freedom; equality-first levelling flags oppression but flattens choice and desert; justice-as-ordering balances them by principle.

- **Indian anchor.** Ambedkar: political democracy (equal votes, formal liberty) is unstable without SOCIAL democracy -- liberty, equality AND fraternity -- so justice must reach lived social standing, not only procedure.

Verdict. Liberty and equality are the substance of a just society, but justice is its FORM: it is the ideal that disciplines and coordinates the other two, and without it each remains normatively incomplete.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it proves inadequacy by showing each ideal is indeterminate about its own content, compares three ordering positions, anchors in Ambedkar, and ends with the architectonic verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "How are both equality and liberty inadequate as social and political ideals without justice? Discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish Rawls's difference principle from Nozick's entitlement theory. Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Distinguish**: define both sides, compare them on common axes, identify the decisive difference and close with its significance. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Rawls's difference principle and Nozick's entitlement theory answer inequality through rival moral tests. Rawls judges institutions by fairness to the least advantaged, while Nozick judges holdings by their history.

Core analysis: For Rawls, equal basic liberties come first, fair equality of opportunity comes next, and only then may inequalities stand if they improve the position of the least advantaged. Nozick rejects such patterned assessment. He asks whether holdings arose through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification of past injustice under a minimal protective state. Rawls therefore evaluates the basic structure prospectively; Nozick evaluates titles historically.

Critical evaluation: Each theory exposes the other's blind spot. Rawls risks underplaying title and incentive, while Nozick leaves structural inequality and rectification seriously under-specified.

Conclusion: Rawls and Nozick disagree not merely over equality but over what makes a holding just: fair institutions ordered to the least advantaged versus historically valid title constrained by rectification.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Distinguish Rawls's difference principle from Nozick's entitlement theory." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is Walzer's complex equality not simple levelling? Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Why**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Walzer's complex equality is not a call for identical shares of every good. It is a doctrine about protecting distinct social spheres from illegitimate conversion by money or power.

Core analysis: Different goods carry different social meanings and should be distributed for different reasons. Political office should not be bought like a commodity, education should not simply follow wealth, and health care should not be reduced to market purchasing power. Simple equality would try to flatten all holdings by one metric. Walzer's alternative is to prevent dominance: advantage in one sphere must not automatically command superiority in another.

Critical evaluation: The view is morally sharp but institutionally thinner than Rawls or Nozick. It explains what should not dominate, yet says less about the precise machinery that secures those boundaries.

Conclusion: Walzer's point is not that every sphere must yield identical shares, but that money or power must not buy dominance across unlike goods with distinct social meanings.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Why is Walzer's complex equality not simple levelling?" - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare feminist and subaltern critiques of distributive justice. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **the stated directive**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Feminist and subaltern critiques challenge justice theories that examine only formal rules or market shares. Both argue that persons enter institutions already marked by hierarchy.

Core analysis: Feminist justice shows that equal treatment is inadequate where gendered burdens structure education, property, representation and bodily security. Gauba's own account allows corrective support, not mere identical treatment. Subaltern justice shifts attention to groups whose labour and contribution are undervalued because elite rule and hegemonic narratives make subordination appear natural or consensual. Both critiques therefore widen justice beyond contract and exchange toward power, dignity and voice.

Further development: The comparison becomes stronger when it asks what each critique adds to distributive theory. Feminist justice highlights the gap between formal rights and effective participation inside household and workplace relations. Subaltern justice highlights how representation and public meaning are monopolised before distribution is even counted. Together they show that status injury and under-valuation can precede and reinforce maldistribution.

Critical evaluation: Yet they should not be collapsed. Feminist analysis begins from patriarchy and gendered exclusion, whereas subaltern analysis centres structurally marginal agency, hegemony and elite-centred history.

Conclusion: Feminist and subaltern critiques deepen distributive justice by showing that formally neutral rules can preserve hierarchy unless power, voice and status injury are made part of the analysis.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Compare feminist and subaltern critiques of distributive justice." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Does Sen improve Rawls, or mainly change the metric of justice? Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Does**: answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Sen's intervention is best read as a reorientation of justice rather than a simple rejection of Rawls. He asks how far institutions enlarge actual capabilities in lived conditions.

Core analysis: Rawls distributes primary goods through principles chosen in the original position for a fair basic structure. Sen argues that equal resources or primary goods can still leave persons unequally free because disability, gendered burdens and social location affect conversion into real functionings. He therefore shifts attention from ideal design to comparative judgment, remediable injustice and public reasoning about what people are actually able to be and do. The metric changes from goods held to freedoms realised.

Further development: The key issue is the criterion of improvement. If justice is judged by real freedom and removal of manifest injustice, Sen clearly advances beyond Rawlsian primary goods. If justice also requires a stable ordering of institutions, liberties and offices, Sen supplements rather than supersedes Rawls. A good answer therefore separates metric, method and institutional determinacy before giving its verdict.

Critical evaluation: Rawls nevertheless retains an advantage in institutional specification. Sen improves the informational space of justice, but deliberately under-specifies a final set of principles for a fully just basic structure.

Conclusion: Sen improves Rawls most clearly by shifting justice from the distribution of primary goods to the comparison of real freedoms, yet he supplements rather than abolishes the need for institutional principles.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Does Sen improve Rawls, or mainly change the metric of justice?" - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Can justice be exhausted by redistribution? Discuss with Rawls, Fraser and Ambedkarian/subaltern implications. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Can**: answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: A purely redistributive account captures only one family of injustice. The justice debate widens once unequal status and exclusion from rule-making are recognised as independent political wrongs.

Core analysis: Rawls remains indispensable because he shows why liberties, opportunity and the position of the least advantaged matter to institutional fairness. Yet redistribution alone cannot explain cases where a group remains stigmatised, unheard or publicly devalued even after material transfers occur. Fraser's parity-of-participation bridge therefore adds recognition and representation to distribution. Ambedkarian and subaltern implications, kept as cross-routes rather than proxy ownership, reinforce the point: graded status, hegemony and monopolised voice cannot be repaired by income measures alone.

Further development: The temporal and democratic dimensions sharpen the argument further. Recognition without representation lets elites speak for the injured, while redistribution without recognition may leave the public meaning of inferiority untouched. At the forward boundary, debates on democratisation, democratic backsliding and social movements belong to Topic 23; Topic 20 should only supply the justice standards later used to judge those processes.

Critical evaluation: Once justice expands beyond redistribution, new problems arise. Duty-bearers must be specified, remedies must remain reviewable, and not every status injury warrants the same institutional response. Otherwise the cure can become paternal or rhetorically expansive without administrative discipline.

Conclusion: Justice cannot be exhausted by redistribution because status subordination and exclusion from rule-making persist even when transfers occur; a defensible answer therefore joins resources, recognition and representation.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Can justice be exhausted by redistribution? Discuss with Rawls, Fraser and Ambedkarian/subaltern implications." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate whether democratic socialism is the strongest correction to both libertarianism and Marxist centralism. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Evaluate**: reconstruct the position accurately, test its strongest objection and reply, then give a graded verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: Democratic socialism presents itself as a middle route between libertarian minimalism and Marxist centralism. It keeps social justice as a public aim while rejecting dictatorship and unregulated market title.

Core analysis: Against libertarianism, democratic socialism argues that formal liberty without welfare, public services and fair life-chances entrenches privilege. Against Marxist centralism, it argues that social ownership or regulation must coexist with freedom of thought, party competition, opposition rights and civil liberties. Gauba's account treats it as a constitutional and welfare-oriented correction: partial socialisation, public services and democratic procedure rather than revolutionary monopoly power.

Further development: The decisive test is democratic durability. Democratic socialism must fund welfare without administrative arbitrariness, protect labour without silencing opposition, and widen equality without concentrating unreviewable power. Where later questions shift to democratisation, backsliding or movement politics, Topic 23 should own the bridge; Topic 20 should stop at the justice-based criteria by which such regimes are judged. It must also balance welfare delivery with secure opposition rights and contestable public power.

Critical evaluation: The position still faces two serious objections. Libertarians question its treatment of title, incentives and state reach, while Marxists question whether capitalism can be humanised without leaving structural domination intact. Its success therefore depends less on slogan than on institutional design.

Conclusion: Democratic socialism is strongest when it corrects market privilege and Marxist authoritarian risk together, but it remains convincing only if welfare, liberty and democratic accountability are kept institutionally connected.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Evaluate whether democratic socialism is the strongest correction to both libertarianism and Marxist centralism." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.